

TC003 / Top500 rank 3

Comment-Before-Question

Phase 5 Batch 1 v24 - full standalone TC001-grade Top500 technique package

Use it when

Best for: Meeting someone new
Following up on a story
Professional discovery without sounding like a checklist
Digital messages where bare questions can feel abrupt
Avoid when: The situation requires a direct urgent question
The comment would be fake
You are stacking multiple questions
The person has asked for a concise...

Say this

That sounds like a big shift. What changed? | That is useful context. What was the constraint? | That is a lot. What was the hardest part?

Core formula

Hear the content -> make one relevant comment -> ask one question -> stop and listen

Avoid this failure

The main failure mode is adding a fake or overlong comment that feels like a scripted preamble before interrogation.

Use to increase clarity, ease and respect - not to pressure, extract or override autonomy.

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Neighbour distinction

TC001 Live-Thread Follow-Ups: TC001 follows the last live thread; TC003 improves the shape of the next question. | TC033 Minimal Encouragers: TC033 uses tiny signals to keep them talking; TC003 adds one substantive comment before a question.

Recovery phrase

That came out more like an interview than I meant

Practice drill

Five-minute drill: write three real situations from the last week where this technique would have helped

Calibration cue

They answer with more detail
They do not tense up at the question
The conversation feels smoother than question-answer-question
They ask you something back later
If the person gives shorter answers, looks tense or corrects the frame, lower intensity immediately.

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